

1. Nasna Nassir

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Brief profile	Dr. Nasna Nassir is Assistant Professor of Human Genetics at the Center for Applied and Translational Genomics, Mohammed Bin Rashid University of Medicine and Health Sciences (MBRU), Dubai Health. Her research focuses on population genomics, Arab and regional pangenome references, long-read sequencing, single-cell and spatial omics, functional genomics, neurogenomics, and precision medicine for underrepresented populations. She has led and contributed to multidisciplinary genomics initiatives spanning rare diseases, neurodevelopmental disorders, translational genomics, and population-scale genomic resources, with publications in high-impact journals including Nature Communications, Nature Medicine, npj Genomic Medicine, iScience, and Human Genomics.

2. Mohamed A. Almarri

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Brief profile	Dr. Mohamed A. Almarri is Assistant Professor of Population Genomics at Mohammed Bin Rashid University of Medicine and Health Sciences and Founding Director of the Genome Center at Dubai Police. His work focuses on population genomics, ancient DNA, bioinformatics, genomic medicine, and Middle Eastern population history. He has contributed to landmark human population genomics studies and leads multidisciplinary initiatives that integrate genomics, forensics, archaeology, and healthcare applications.

3. Muhammad Kumail

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Affiliation	Center for Applied and Translational Genomics (CATG), Mohammed Bin Rashid University of Medicine and Health Sciences, Dubai Health, Dubai, UAE
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Brief profile	Muhammad Kumail is a Bioinformatician at the Center for Applied and Translational Genomics, MBRU/Dubai Health. He develops computational pipelines and infrastructure for large-scale genomics research, including pangenome construction, genome assembly, assembly quality assessment, variant detection, single-cell genomics, and population genetics. With a background in computer engineering, software development, artificial intelligence, and high-performance computing, he supports translational genomics through robust analytical workflows and data-driven interpretation.

4. Nesrin Mohamed

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Brief profile	Nesrin Mohamed is a clinical research scientist with experience in translational genomics, precision medicine, multi-omics technologies, biomarker discovery, neuroscience, and therapeutic development. She previously served as Research Specialist at the Center for Applied and Translational Genomics, Dubai Health/MBRU, where she provided scientific and laboratory support for genomics, proteomics, metabolomics, single-cell, and mass spectrometry workflows. Her background includes a Master's degree in Drug Discovery and Development and training in pharmacy and biomedical research.

5. Bipin Balan

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Brief profile	Dr. Bipin Balan is a bioinformatician at the Center for Applied and Translational Genomics, Dubai Health, with approximately 17 years of bioinformatics and research experience. He holds a PhD from the University of Palermo, Italy, and an MSc in Bioinformatics. His expertise includes genomics, population-scale data analysis, sequencing data processing, structural variation analysis, transcriptomics, and computational pipeline development. He has authored peer-reviewed publications and contributed bioinformatics expertise to the Arab Pangenome Reference project.

6. Shehzad Hanif

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Brief profile	Shehzad Hanif is a bioinformatics specialist at the Center for Applied and Translational Genomics, MBRU/Dubai Health, with a computer science background and experience in genomics, machine learning, and high-performance computing. His work includes developing and maintaining high-throughput sequencing pipelines for variant calling, structural variant detection, phasing, genome assembly processing, pangenome analysis, and multi-omics integration. He has experience with PacBio, Oxford Nanopore, Illumina, transcriptomic, proteomic, and population genomic datasets.

7. Maryam AIObathani

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Brief profile	Maryam AIObathani is a Research Assistant at the Center for Applied and Translational Genomics, Dubai Health, with expertise in genomics, next-generation sequencing, and laboratory operations. Her work focuses on the Arab Pangenome Reference project and related population genomics initiatives, including sample processing, sequencing coordination, laboratory workflow execution, and research support for large-scale genomic studies.

8. Bassam Jamalalail

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Brief profile	Bassam Jamalalail is a Research Genetic Counselor at Mohammed Bin Rashid University of Medicine and Health Sciences with experience in genetic research, patient counseling, research participant coordination, and academic contributions. He holds a Master of Science in Human Genetics - Genetic Counseling from King Abdulaziz University and a Bachelor of Science in Cell and Molecular Biology. His work includes participant recruitment, genetic counseling, research documentation, genetic testing coordination, interdisciplinary collaboration, and ethical and legal compliance in genetics research.

9. Hanan Elsokary

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Affiliation	Center for Applied and Translational Genomics (CATG), Mohammed Bin Rashid University of Medicine and Health Sciences, Dubai Health, Dubai, UAE
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Brief profile	Hanan Elsokary is a Research Assistant at Mohammed Bin Rashid University of Medicine and Health Sciences with expertise in molecular genetics, genomics, and advanced sequencing technologies. Her work focuses on whole-genome sequencing, transcriptomic workflows, sample processing, and laboratory support for population genomics and multi-omics research. She contributed to DNA and RNA sequencing activities for the Arab Pangenome Reference project.

10. Dasuki Kondaramage

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Brief profile	Dasuki Kondaramage is a graduate scientist and Research Assistant at Mohammed Bin Rashid University of Medicine and Health Sciences with experience in molecular biotechnology, next-generation sequencing, transcriptomics, population genomics, and multi-omics analysis. He has worked on the Arab Pangenome project and related research activities involving Oxford Nanopore and PacBio long-read sequencing, laboratory workflow execution, troubleshooting of sequencing outputs, sample database management, inventory management, and training of interns and medical students.

11. Suhana Shiyas

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Affiliation	Center for Applied and Translational Genomics (CATG), Mohammed Bin Rashid University of Medicine and Health Sciences, Dubai Health, Dubai, UAE
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Brief profile	Suhana Shiyas is a Research Assistant at the Center for Applied and Translational Genomics, MBRU/Dubai Health, with expertise in genomics, genome sequencing, stem cell biology, and functional genomics. Her work includes support for large-scale genomic and pangenomic studies, visualization of complex genomic loci, pangenome graph creation, and research activities related to neurodevelopmental and translational genomics.

12. Noor Kosaji

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Brief profile	Noor Kosaji is a PhD candidate in Biomedical Sciences at Mohammed Bin Rashid University of Medicine and Health Sciences with a background in biomedical engineering. Her research interests include neurodevelopmental genomics, single-cell technologies, disease etiology, and precision medicine inclusivity. She has authored and co-authored publications in genomics and neurodevelopmental disorders, including work highlighting the impact of limited ethnic diversity in single-cell transcriptomics. She contributed to pangenome visualization, complex loci analysis, and graph creation activities.

13. Dharana Satsangi

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Affiliation	College of Medicine, Mohammed Bin Rashid University of Medicine and Health Sciences, Dubai Health, Dubai, UAE
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Brief profile	Dharana Satsangi is a biologist with training in biotechnology and regenerative medicine and experience in molecular and cellular research. She previously worked as a Research Assistant at Mohammed Bin Rashid University of Medicine and Health Sciences, contributing to sequencing and genomics projects, including the Arab Pangenome Reference. Her expertise includes regenerative medicine, stem cell processing, molecular biology, next-generation sequencing support, and research activities across genomics, cancer biology, and translational biomedical science.

14. Madiha Hamdi Saif Abdelmotagali

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Brief profile	Madiha Hamdi Saif Abdelmotagali is a Senior Staff Nurse, Research Coordinator, and certified BLS/ACLS Instructor with extensive experience in clinical care, healthcare education, and research support. Her expertise spans emergency and critical care nursing, patient and participant coordination, clinical documentation, sample collection support, and implementation of healthcare research activities within Dubai Health.

15. Ahmad Abou Tayoun

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Brief profile	Dr. Ahmad Abou Tayoun is a clinical molecular geneticist, Full Professor of Genetics at Mohammed Bin Rashid University of Medicine and Health Sciences, and Director of the Dubai Health Genomic Medicine Center. He works on advancing genomic services for underserved populations, particularly in the Middle East, and collaborates with regional and international teams on genomic discoveries, clinical genomics, variant interpretation, rare disease diagnostics, training programs, and guidelines for wider adoption of human genomics in healthcare.

16. Olfat Zuhair Salem Ahmed

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Brief profile	Olfat Zuhair Salem Ahmed is an experienced Assistant Nurse with more than 25 years of service in hospital and primary care settings. Her expertise includes patient care, maternal health support, triage, vaccination assistance, infection control, and research participation. She has served as a research team member in international collaborative studies and contributed to data collection, participant follow-up, and clinical research support within Dubai Health.

17. Douaa Fathi Youssef

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Brief profile	Douaa Fathi Youssef is a Senior Staff Nurse in Preventive and Promotive Health Services at Dubai Health, with extensive experience in clinical care, preventive health, and community-based healthcare programs. She has contributed to clinical research operations, participant coordination, data collection, sample collection support, and public health-related research activities across Dubai Health programs.

18. Hanan Al Suwaidi

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Brief profile	Dr. Hanan Al Suwaidi is Deputy CEO and Chief Academic Officer of Dubai Health and Provost of Mohammed Bin Rashid University of Medicine and Health Sciences. She is an Emirati family physician, academic leader, and member of the Dubai Health Board of Directors representing MBRU. She has played a major role in Dubai Health's transformation and strategic direction, is recognized as the UAE's first Emirati Space Flight Surgeon, and has contributed significantly to healthcare leadership, academic medicine, public health, and national healthcare initiatives.

19. Ammar Albanna

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Brief profile	Dr. Ammar Humaid Albanna is Director of Al Amal Mental Health Hospital, Consultant Child and Adolescent Psychiatrist, and an academic and healthcare leader. He is founding head of the Child Mental Health Center of Excellence and founding president of the Emirates Society for Child and Adolescent Mental Health. His expertise spans clinical psychiatry, autism and developmental disorders, mental health systems, research leadership, innovation in mental health, and academic program development. He holds fellowship training from Canada and a Master's in Healthcare Leadership from McGill University.

20. Stefan S Du Plessis

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Brief profile	Professor Stefan S Du Plessis is Dean of Research and Graduate Studies and Professor of Physiology at Mohammed Bin Rashid University of Medicine and Health Sciences. He is an internationally recognized researcher with extensive experience in reproductive biology, physiology, biomedical research, graduate education, and research leadership. His academic work spans translational research, research strategy, training, supervision, and institutional research development.

21. Hamda Hassan Khansaheb

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Brief profile	Dr. Hamda Hassan Khansaheb is Director of Research Administration and Support at MBRU/Dubai Health, Consultant Family Medicine, and Associate Professor of Family Medicine. She has extensive experience in clinical practice, medical research administration, public health, healthcare management, and academic medicine. Her training includes family medicine, public health, medical education, research training at Harvard Medical School, and healthcare management. She contributes to research governance, participant recruitment, clinical data collection, and institutional research support.

22. Alawi Alsheikh-Ali

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Brief profile	Dr. Alawi Alsheikh-Ali is Director General of Dubai Health Authority and Professor of Cardiovascular Medicine at Mohammed Bin Rashid University of Medicine and Health Sciences. He previously served as Deputy CEO and Chief Academic Officer of Dubai Health, Provost of MBRU, and Founding Dean of the College of Medicine. He is a clinician-scientist with training in internal medicine, cardiology, clinical cardiac electrophysiology, and clinical research, and has held leadership roles across healthcare, academic medicine, research governance, public health, and national scientific initiatives.

23. Mohammed Uddin

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Brief profile	Dr. Mohammed Uddin is Founding Director of the Center for Applied and Translational Genomics and Associate Professor of Human Genetics at Mohammed Bin Rashid University of Medicine and Health Sciences. His research focuses on human genetics, neurodevelopmental disorders, single-cell and multi-omics technologies, machine learning, clinical genomics, pangenomics, and therapeutic development. He has co-published more than 80 papers in high-impact journals, developed patented approaches for variant interpretation, and leads multidisciplinary programs integrating genomics, AI, mRNA/antisense therapeutics, and precision medicine.